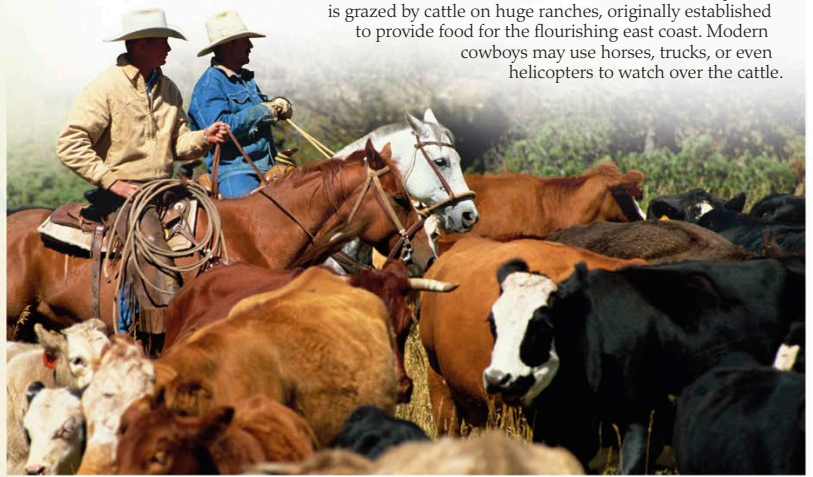




CATTLE RANCHES

Many people who live in Montana, Wyoming, Utah, and Colorado work in the booming farming and mining industries. Much of the land on these foothills and plains is grazed by cattle on huge ranches, originally established to provide food for the flourishing east coast. Modern cowboys may use horses, trucks, or even helicopters to watch over the cattle.



DEATH VALLEY

The driest place in the US is Death Valley, which also holds the highest recorded temperature in North America of 134°F (56.7°C). Although seemingly inhospitable, its canyons, formations of rock, and sudden spring blooms make it popular with tourists.

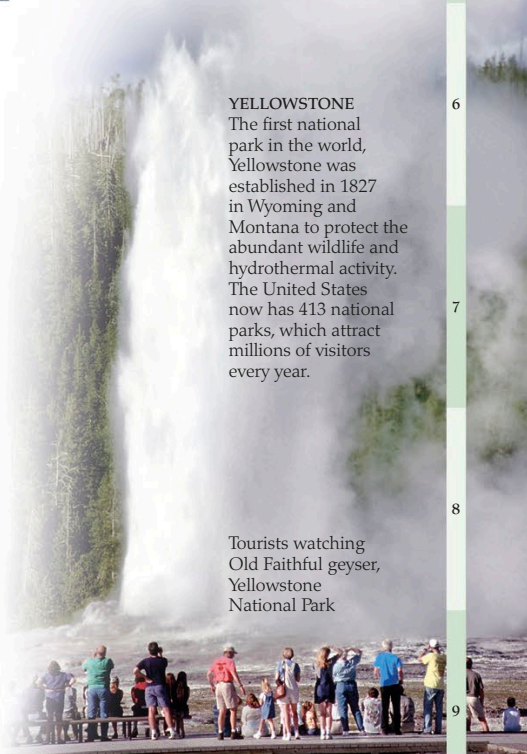


COLORADO

The Rocky Mountains cut through this region. The stunning terrain and the light, dry snow that falls here support the skiing industry in Colorado. Resorts such as Aspen are popular with Americans as well as with overseas visitors.

YELLOWSTONE

The first national park in the world, Yellowstone was established in 1827 in Wyoming and Montana to protect the abundant wildlife and hydrothermal activity. The United States now has 413 national parks, which attract millions of visitors every year.



Tourists watching Old Faithful geyser, Yellowstone National Park

EARTHQUAKES

San Francisco in California suffers frequent earthquakes due to its location on the San Andreas fault line. Modern skyscrapers are designed to withstand tremors, but many houses, especially those on typically steep streets, are still at risk.



Silicon, an element, is used in many computer products.

SILICON VALLEY

The area between Palo Alto and San Jose has been nicknamed "Silicon Valley" because of the many companies engaged in high-technology research and manufacturing here. It is the center of the world's computer industry.